



NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR INNOVATION & ENTREPRENEURSHIP (NCIE) INDIA

Grievance Redressal & Stakeholder Protection

Multi-Tier Escalation Ladder, Time-Bound SLAs & Whistleblower Rights

Structured complaint redressal mechanism across 10 grievance categories; time-bound SLAs (2-3 days acknowledgement, 15-30 days resolution), 5-tier escalation ladder, and whistleblower non-retaliation protections.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTERIAL COORDINATION & ALIGNMENT

MSDE

Skill Development &
Entrepreneurship

MSME

Micro, Small &
Medium Enterprises

MeitY

Electronics &
Information Technology

MCA

Ministry of
Corporate Affairs

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SUPPORTING NATIONAL INITIATIVES & STRATEGIC ALLIANCES



NCIE GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Policy Area: Grievance Handling, Complaints, Feedback, Appeals & Stakeholder Protection

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1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Grievance Redressal Policy** establishes a structured, accessible and transparent mechanism for receiving, registering, examining and resolving grievances and complaints relating to NCIE programmes, services, institutional activities, partnerships and authorised operations.

The policy is intended to provide students, trainees, innovators, entrepreneurs, educational institutions, faculty members, mentors, trainers, employees, partners, beneficiaries and other stakeholders with an appropriate mechanism to raise concerns and receive a fair and timely response.

NCIE shall seek to handle grievances in a manner that promotes **fairness, confidentiality, accountability, non-discrimination, transparency and continuous improvement**.

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2. OBJECTIVES

The policy aims to:

- Provide an accessible grievance mechanism.
- Enable stakeholders to submit complaints and concerns.
- Ensure grievances are properly recorded and tracked.
- Establish a structured review and resolution process.
- Provide appropriate acknowledgement and responses.
- Protect complainants from retaliation for raising genuine concerns.
- Maintain confidentiality to the extent reasonably possible.
- Identify recurring issues and systemic weaknesses.

- Improve programme and institutional processes.
 - Strengthen stakeholder confidence and accountability.
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3. SCOPE

This policy may apply to grievances concerning:

- NCIE programmes
- Registration and applications
- Programme fees
- Attendance
- Training and curriculum
- Assessments
- Certification
- Scholarships and student support
- Mentorship
- Innovation and startup programmes
- Institutional onboarding
- Partner institutions
- Programme implementation
- Staff or programme conduct
- Communication and public information
- Funding-related programme processes
- Digital platforms
- Administrative services
- Other NCIE-authorised activities

Where a matter is governed by a separate statutory or specialised mechanism, it may be referred to the appropriate authority or mechanism.

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4. WHO MAY FILE A GRIEVANCE

The grievance mechanism may be available to:

- Students
- Trainees
- Youth participants
- Innovators

- Entrepreneurs
 - Startup founders
 - Faculty members
 - Educational institutions
 - Trainers
 - Mentors
 - Employees
 - Volunteers
 - Beneficiaries
 - Institutional partners
 - CSR partners
 - Other programme stakeholders
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5. TYPES OF GRIEVANCES

A. Programme Grievances

Concerns relating to programme implementation, schedule, participation or delivery.

B. Registration Grievances

Issues concerning registration, application, eligibility or documentation.

C. Academic / Training Grievances

Concerns relating to training, curriculum, trainers, assessments or learning activities.

D. Certification Grievances

Issues relating to certificate eligibility, completion status or certificate issuance.

E. Financial / Fee Grievances

Concerns relating to programme fees, payments, receipts or approved financial processes.

F. Institutional Grievances

Concerns relating to institutional onboarding, programme coordination or institutional participation.

G. Staff / Conduct Grievances

Complaints concerning inappropriate conduct, professional behaviour or violation of organisational procedures.

H. Digital Platform Grievances

Issues relating to registration portals, attendance systems, certificates, login access or digital services.

I. Partnership Grievances

Concerns relating to implementation of an authorised partnership or collaboration.

J. Public Information Grievances

Concerns regarding inaccurate, outdated or misleading information published through authorised NCIE channels.

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6. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL PRINCIPLES

NCIE grievance handling shall be guided by:

Accessibility

Stakeholders should have a reasonably accessible mechanism for raising concerns.

Fairness

Complaints should be considered objectively.

Impartiality

Where practical, a person directly involved in the complaint should not be the sole decision-maker regarding that complaint.

Confidentiality

Information should be handled confidentially to the extent reasonably possible.

Timeliness

Grievances should be processed within appropriate timelines.

Non-Retaliation

Good-faith complainants should not face retaliation merely for raising a legitimate concern.

Evidence-Based Review

Decisions should be based on available records and relevant information.

Documentation

Important actions and decisions should be appropriately recorded.

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7. GRIEVANCE CHANNELS

NCIE may provide one or more authorised channels, including:

- Official grievance email
- Website grievance form
- Online complaint portal
- Institutional nodal officer
- Programme coordinator
- Written complaint
- Official communication channels

The currently authorised contact details should be displayed on the official NCIE website and programme documentation.

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8. GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

A grievance should, where possible, contain:

- Name of complainant

- Contact details
- Programme / institution
- Nature of grievance
- Description of the issue
- Relevant date
- Supporting documents, if available
- Expected resolution, where appropriate

Anonymous complaints may be considered where the nature of the matter permits meaningful examination.

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9. GRIEVANCE REGISTRATION

Each grievance received through an authorised channel may be assigned a unique:

Grievance Reference Number

The reference may be used for:

- Tracking
- Internal review
- Communication
- Resolution
- Closure

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10. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL PROCESS

The standard process shall be:

GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

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REGISTRATION & REFERENCE NUMBER



PRELIMINARY REVIEW



ASSIGNMENT TO RESPONSIBLE FUNCTION



FACT & DOCUMENT REVIEW



STAKEHOLDER RESPONSE, WHERE REQUIRED



DECISION / CORRECTIVE ACTION



COMMUNICATION OF OUTCOME



CLOSURE



APPEAL / REVIEW, WHERE APPLICABLE



11. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

NCIE should, where technically and operationally feasible, acknowledge receipt of a grievance and provide a reference number.

The acknowledgement may communicate:

- Receipt of grievance
- Reference number
- Expected next step
- Additional information required, if any

12. PRELIMINARY REVIEW

The grievance may initially be reviewed to determine:

- Whether it falls within NCIE's scope.
 - Whether sufficient information is available.
 - Whether urgent action is required.
 - Whether another authority is more appropriate.
 - Whether additional documents are required.
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13. PRIORITY CLASSIFICATION

Grievances may be classified according to their nature and urgency.

Routine

General programme or administrative concern.

Priority

Matter requiring relatively prompt intervention.

Urgent

Matter involving significant programme disruption, safety concerns, serious misconduct or other circumstances requiring immediate attention.

The actual response period may depend on the nature and complexity of the matter.

14. INVESTIGATION / FACT-FINDING

Where necessary, NCIE may conduct an appropriate fact-finding review involving:

- Relevant records
- Programme data

- Attendance records
- Registration information
- Financial records
- Statements
- Institutional records
- Digital system records
- Other relevant evidence

The extent of review shall depend on the nature of the grievance.

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15. RESPONSE FROM CONCERNED PARTIES

Where appropriate, the person, team, institution or function concerned may be provided an opportunity to explain or respond to the issue.

The objective is to ensure that decisions are not based solely on an unverified allegation.

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16. GRIEVANCE DECISION

Following review, the grievance may be classified as:

Resolved

Appropriate corrective action has been completed.

Partially Resolved

Some aspects have been addressed while other actions remain.

Not Substantiated

Available evidence does not establish the complaint.

Outside Scope

The matter does not fall within the applicable NCIE mechanism.

Referred

The matter has been referred to an appropriate authority or specialised mechanism.

Rejected

The grievance may be rejected where it is clearly frivolous, abusive, repetitive without new information or otherwise unsuitable for processing, subject to appropriate review.

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17. CORRECTIVE ACTION

Corrective measures may include:

- Correction of records
- Reprocessing of an application
- Clarification of programme information
- Attendance correction where verified
- Certificate correction
- Administrative correction
- Additional communication
- Programme process improvement
- Staff guidance or training
- Institutional coordination
- Other appropriate corrective measures

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18. GRIEVANCE RESPONSE

The response should, where appropriate, communicate:

- Issue considered
- Findings
- Decision
- Corrective action
- Further requirements
- Appeal or review option, where available

Confidential information concerning other individuals should not be disclosed.

19. TARGET REDRESSAL TIMELINES

NCIE may establish indicative internal timelines such as:

Stage	Indicative Timeline
Acknowledge ment	2–3 working days
Preliminary review	Up to 7 working days
Standard resolution	15–30 working days
Complex matter	Additional time where necessary
Appeal / review	As specified in the applicable mechanism

These are **indicative administrative targets**, not statutory deadlines, unless a specific law, agreement or programme guideline provides otherwise.

Where additional time is required, the complainant may be informed appropriately.

20. APPEAL / REVIEW MECHANISM

Where a complainant is dissatisfied with the outcome, an appeal or review may be submitted where such mechanism is available.

The appeal should normally identify:

- Original grievance reference
- Original decision
- Grounds for review
- Additional evidence, if available

An appeal should preferably be reviewed by an appropriate authority not

directly responsible for the original decision, where practical.

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21. ESCALATION FRAMEWORK

The escalation pathway may be:

PROGRAMME COORDINATOR

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PROGRAMME / FUNCTION HEAD

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**GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL OFFICER / DESIGNATED
AUTHORITY**

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AUTHORISED SENIOR MANAGEMENT

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EXTERNAL / COMPETENT AUTHORITY WHERE REQUIRED

The exact structure may vary depending on the nature of the grievance.

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22. SPECIALISED GRIEVANCES

Certain matters may require separate handling under applicable laws or specialised institutional mechanisms.

Examples may include:

- Workplace-related statutory matters
- Sexual harassment complaints
- Child safeguarding concerns
- Financial fraud allegations
- Criminal allegations
- Data-protection matters

- Serious safety concerns

Such matters should be referred to the appropriate legally competent or specialised mechanism rather than being treated as ordinary programme complaints.

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23. NON-RETALIATION

NCIE should seek to protect individuals who raise genuine concerns in good faith.

Retaliation, intimidation or adverse action solely because a person submitted a legitimate grievance should not be permitted.

This protection does not prevent appropriate action where a complaint is deliberately fabricated, malicious or submitted in bad faith.

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24. CONFIDENTIALITY

Information concerning a grievance should be shared only with persons who reasonably require access for:

- Review
- Investigation
- Decision-making
- Legal or compliance purposes
- Resolution

Confidentiality shall be maintained subject to applicable law and legitimate disclosure requirements.

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25. DATA PROTECTION

Grievance records may contain personal or sensitive information.

NCIE should implement appropriate controls concerning:

- Access
- Storage
- Confidentiality
- Data sharing
- Retention
- Secure disposal

Personal information should not be publicly disclosed unnecessarily.

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26. FALSE OR MALICIOUS COMPLAINTS

NCIE may take appropriate action where there is credible evidence that a complaint was intentionally fabricated or submitted maliciously.

However, a grievance should not be treated as malicious merely because:

- It is not substantiated.
- The complainant is mistaken.
- The complainant disagrees with a decision.

Good-faith complaints should be treated fairly even when they are ultimately not established.

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27. REPEATED GRIEVANCES

Repeated complaints concerning the same matter may be consolidated where appropriate.

However, a new grievance should be considered where:

- New evidence is presented.
- Circumstances have materially changed.
- A previous resolution has not been implemented.

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28. GRIEVANCE MIS

NCIE may maintain a digital grievance management system containing:

- Reference number
- Date received
- Category
- Programme
- Institution
- Responsible function
- Status
- Actions taken
- Resolution
- Closure date
- Appeal status

Access should be restricted to authorised personnel.

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29. GRIEVANCE STATUS

The system may use the following status categories:

RECEIVED

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ACKNOWLEDGED

↓

UNDER REVIEW

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INFORMATION REQUESTED

↓

UNDER INVESTIGATION

↓

ACTION REQUIRED

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RESOLVED



CLOSED



APPEAL / REVIEW



30. GRIEVANCE PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

NCIE may monitor:

- Number of grievances received
- Number acknowledged
- Number resolved
- Resolution rate
- Average resolution time
- Pending grievances
- Escalated grievances
- Appeals received
- Appeals resolved
- Recurring grievances
- Corrective actions implemented
- Stakeholder satisfaction



31. ROOT-CAUSE ANALYSIS

Recurring or significant grievances may be analysed to identify underlying causes.

GRIEVANCE



ROOT-CAUSE IDENTIFICATION



PROCESS GAP



CORRECTIVE ACTION



SYSTEM IMPROVEMENT

This ensures that grievance management contributes to continuous organisational improvement.



32. STAKEHOLDER FEEDBACK

Grievance trends and stakeholder feedback may be incorporated into:

- Programme redesign
- Curriculum improvement
- Staff training
- Digital platform improvement
- Institutional coordination
- Communication improvement
- Policy revision



33. PUBLIC GRIEVANCE INFORMATION

The NCIE website may publish:

- Grievance submission process
- Official grievance contact
- General categories of grievances
- Expected response process
- Escalation mechanism
- Relevant policy
- Frequently asked questions

Individual grievance details should remain confidential unless disclosure is legally required or appropriately authorised.



34. ANNUAL GRIEVANCE REVIEW

NCIE may periodically review:

- Total grievances
- Category-wise grievances
- Resolution performance
- Recurring issues
- Response timelines
- Appeals
- Corrective actions
- Process improvements

A summary of grievance performance may be incorporated into an annual institutional or transparency report where appropriate.

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35. GOVERNANCE RESPONSIBILITY

The grievance mechanism may operate through:

NCIE GOVERNANCE / AUTHORISED MANAGEMENT

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DESIGNATED GRIEVANCE AUTHORITY

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PROGRAMME / FUNCTION HEADS

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INSTITUTIONAL NODAL PERSONS

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PROGRAMME TEAMS

The responsibilities of each function should be formally assigned according to organisational requirements.

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36. RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE DESIGNATED GRIEVANCE AUTHORITY

The designated authority may be responsible for:

- Receiving or overseeing grievances.
- Maintaining grievance records.
- Assigning complaints.
- Monitoring timelines.
- Coordinating investigations.
- Communicating decisions.
- Monitoring corrective actions.
- Maintaining confidentiality.
- Preparing grievance reports.
- Identifying systemic issues.

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37. RESPONSIBILITIES OF PROGRAMME TEAMS

Programme teams should:

- Respond to assigned grievances.
- Provide relevant records.
- Cooperate with fact-finding.
- Implement approved corrective actions.
- Maintain accurate programme documentation.
- Prevent recurrence of identified process failures.

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38. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL FLOW

STAKEHOLDER

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GRIEVANCE SUBMISSION

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REFERENCE NUMBER

**PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT****FACT VERIFICATION****DECISION****CORRECTIVE ACTION****STAKEHOLDER RESPONSE****CLOSURE / APPEAL****39. INTEGRATION WITH NCIE TRANSPARENCY POLICY**

The Grievance Redressal Policy complements the **NCIE Transparency & Public Disclosure Policy** by providing a mechanism through which stakeholders can report:

- Incorrect public information
- Programme communication concerns
- Partnership representation concerns
- Funding communication concerns
- Administrative issues
- Other legitimate institutional concerns

Verified corrections may be reflected in public information where appropriate.



40. INTEGRATION WITH MONITORING & EVALUATION

Grievance information may form part of NCIE's broader **Monitoring & Evaluation Framework**.

Grievance trends can provide evidence for:

- Programme quality assessment
- Service improvement
- Institutional performance
- Risk identification
- Process redesign
- Beneficiary satisfaction

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41. INTEGRATION WITH GOVERNANCE & COMPLIANCE

The grievance mechanism forms part of NCIE's broader governance system alongside:

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Financial controls
- Programme monitoring
- Risk management
- Internal review
- Compliance
- Data protection

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42. GRIEVANCE RECORD RETENTION

Grievance records should be retained for an appropriate period based on:

- Applicable legal requirements
- Programme requirements
- Funding agreements
- Organisational policies
- Nature of the grievance

Records should be securely maintained and accessible only to authorised

personnel.

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43. POLICY REVIEW

This policy should be reviewed periodically to consider:

- Changes in applicable law
- Regulatory developments
- Organisational changes
- Programme expansion
- Stakeholder feedback
- Grievance trends
- Lessons learned

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44. POLICY COMMITMENT

NCIE is committed to providing a fair, accessible, transparent and accountable grievance redressal mechanism through which stakeholders can raise legitimate concerns relating to programmes, services, institutional activities and authorised operations.

NCIE shall seek to acknowledge, examine and resolve grievances in a timely and impartial manner while maintaining appropriate confidentiality and protecting personal information.

The grievance mechanism is intended not only to resolve individual concerns but also to identify recurring issues, strengthen institutional processes and continuously improve the quality and effectiveness of NCIE programmes.

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45. OVERALL GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL MODEL

LISTEN → REGISTER → REVIEW → VERIFY → RESOLVE → RESPOND → IMPROVE

NCIE's grievance redressal system is intended to strengthen stakeholder confidence, institutional accountability and continuous improvement by ensuring that legitimate concerns are appropriately received, examined, documented and addressed through a structured process.